

Table 6.6 Datasets Considered

# Dataset and Source	Number of Asset Classes Tested	Time Period	Abbreviation
1. Ten sector portfolios of the S&P 500 and the US equity market portfolio	11	01/1981–12/2002	S&P Sectors
2. Ten industry portfolios and the US equity market portfolio	11	07/1963–11/2004	Industry
3. Eight country indexes and the World Index	9	01/1970–07/2001	International
4. SMB and HML portfolios and the US equity market portfolio	3	07/1963–11/2004	MKT/SMB/HML
5. Twenty size- and book-to-market portfolios and the US equity MKT	21	07/1963–11/2004	FF-1-factor
6. Twenty size- and book-to-market portfolios and the MKT, SMB, and HML portfolios	23	07/1963–11/2004	FF-3-factor
7. Twenty size- and book-to-market portfolios and the MKT, SMB, HML, and UMD portfolios	24	07/1963–11/2004	FF-4-factor
8. Simulated data	10,25,50	2000 years	—

What they found was remarkable. *Equal-weight portfolios meet or beat all of the fancy portfolios.* [Table 6.7](#) summarizes the Sharpe ratio results from the original paper. You'll quickly note that the equal-weight strategy has robust performance across the various test assets relative to the fancier alternatives. You'll also identify that the in-sample mean-variance (labeled “mv (in-sample)”) stats are amazing, but they are also unattainable in a real-